

Milestone 3 – Prioritisation, Metrics and Growth

Discreet Voice mode for ChatGPT

Enabling private, professional voice input to unlock adoption among the students in India.

Team: Product

Status: In Review

Resources: Milestone [1](#) & [2](#)

Contributors: Shivam Kumar Gupta

Launching on: TBD

Problem Definition

Many Indian mobile users shy away from using ChatGPT's voice input because speaking out loud in shared or professional spaces feels awkward and makes them worry about making mistakes; on top of that, the voice experience itself feels like an afterthought, with poor discoverability, weak onboarding, and unclear feedback while it's listening or processing.

What is the problem?

Indian mobile users do not adopt voice input or ChatGPT because they feel uncomfortable and lack of confidence using voice in shared or professional environment.

Who is the problem?

Indian college students aged 18–25 using ChatGPT on mobile.

What business value will be unlocked by solving it?

Bridging this gap among students can drive 3–4x voice usage and boost engagement by reducing privacy hesitation and typing defaults.

How will target users benefit if the problem is solved?

They gain faster, hands-free productivity, easier thought capture, natural conversational.

Why is it urgent to solve this now?

There is a narrow window to close the awareness–adoption gap as India becomes voice-first and before competitors shape user habits. High trial but low retention (73% try, 11% stay) highlights significant untapped value.

Goals

Increase voice usage adoption among working professionals on ChatGPT

Reduce user discomfort during voice input in shared or professional

Improve user trust in voice accuracy and control for work-related tasks.

Measurable Metrics

Functional Metrics

Metric	What it Measures
Weekly Active Voice Users (WAV – Voice)	% of weekly active mobile users using voice input
7-Day Voice Retention	% of first-time voice users who return to use voice again within 7 days
Voice Task Completion Rate	% of voice sessions successfully completed without switching
Voice CSAT	User satisfaction score (1–5) for voice interactions

Non-Functional Metrics

Metric	What it Measures
Transcription Accuracy	% of correctly recognized user speech
Latency	Time from voice completion to visible transcription/response
Voice Session Failure Rate	% of voice attempts that crash or error
Voice Cut-Off Rate	% of sessions where speech is interrupted

Why these Metrics Are Important

- **Adoption:** Are students using voice comfortably in shared spaces?
- **Habit:** Are they replacing typing with voice for study tasks?
- **Trust:** Do they trust accuracy and privacy (Incognito)?
- **Quality:** Does voice work reliably in noisy, real-world environments?

Non-Goals

- Redesigning the full voice conversation or assistant experience.
- Expanding voice input to desktop or web platforms.
- Improving core speech recognition models or adding new language support.
- Introducing monetization, incentives, or gamification to drive voice usage.

Validation of the Problem

- **Quantitative findings:**
73% of students have tried voice input, but only 11% use it regularly, indicating high post-trial drop-off. 44% report “forgetting the feature exists,” while ~30% feel social discomfort or privacy concerns when using voice in shared environments like hostels, libraries, or public spaces.
- **Qualitative insights:**
Students avoid using voice due to fear of being overheard, judged, or sounding awkward in shared environments. Many also report speech cut-offs and inaccuracies, reducing trust in voice for academic use like doubts, explanations, or revision.
- **Context patterns:**
Although most usage happens on mobile during study hours or multitasking scenarios, students default to typing because voice does not fit shared or noisy environments.
- **Competitive comparison:**
Students are comfortable using voice on apps like WhatsApp and Google Assistant, indicating that the issue is not with voice itself but with product-specific limitations in ChatGPT (privacy, control, and discoverability).

Understanding the target audience

Target Segment:

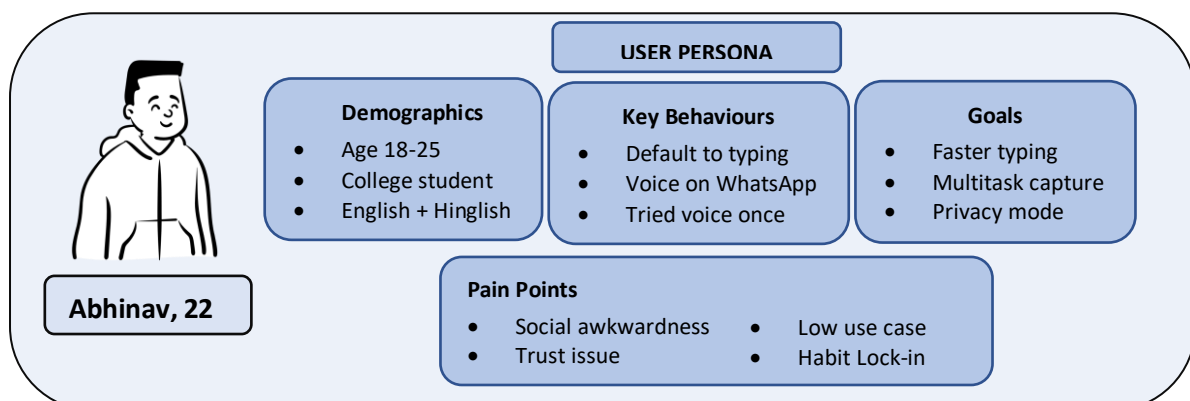
Indian college students aged **18–25** who use ChatGPT on mobile for academic tasks such as doubt-solving, summarization, coding help, exam preparation, and brainstorming.

Segment Size:

Approximately **100M+ students** across India, representing a large, mobile-first, and high-engagement user segment for ChatGPT.

Unmet Needs:

- **Reliable transcription:** Confidence that voice input understands accents and Hinglish/mixed language accurately
- **Control & editability:** Ability to review and edit voice input before sending for better academic accuracy
- **Habit integration:** Voice should feel natural for quick doubts and study tasks, not just an occasional feature



Solution

Three solution directions were explored and prioritized based on impact, reach, and confidence.

Solution	Description	Impact	Reach	Confidence	Rationale
Frictionless Voice Access	Enable faster and easier voice access using "Hey ChatGPT" wake word and visible mic entry to reduce typing default behaviour	High	High	Medium	Improves discoverability and reduces friction to start voice
Private & Controlled Voice Experience	Provide headphone privacy nudges, push-to-talk interaction, noise suppression, listening feedback, and incognito mode	Very High	Medium	High	Directly solves privacy concerns, social discomfort, and trust issues
Engagement & Personalization	Allow theme/background customization and personalized interface to increase engagement and habit formation	Medium	Medium	Medium	Improves engagement and emotional connection but does not solve core adoption barrier

Rationale for Final Choice

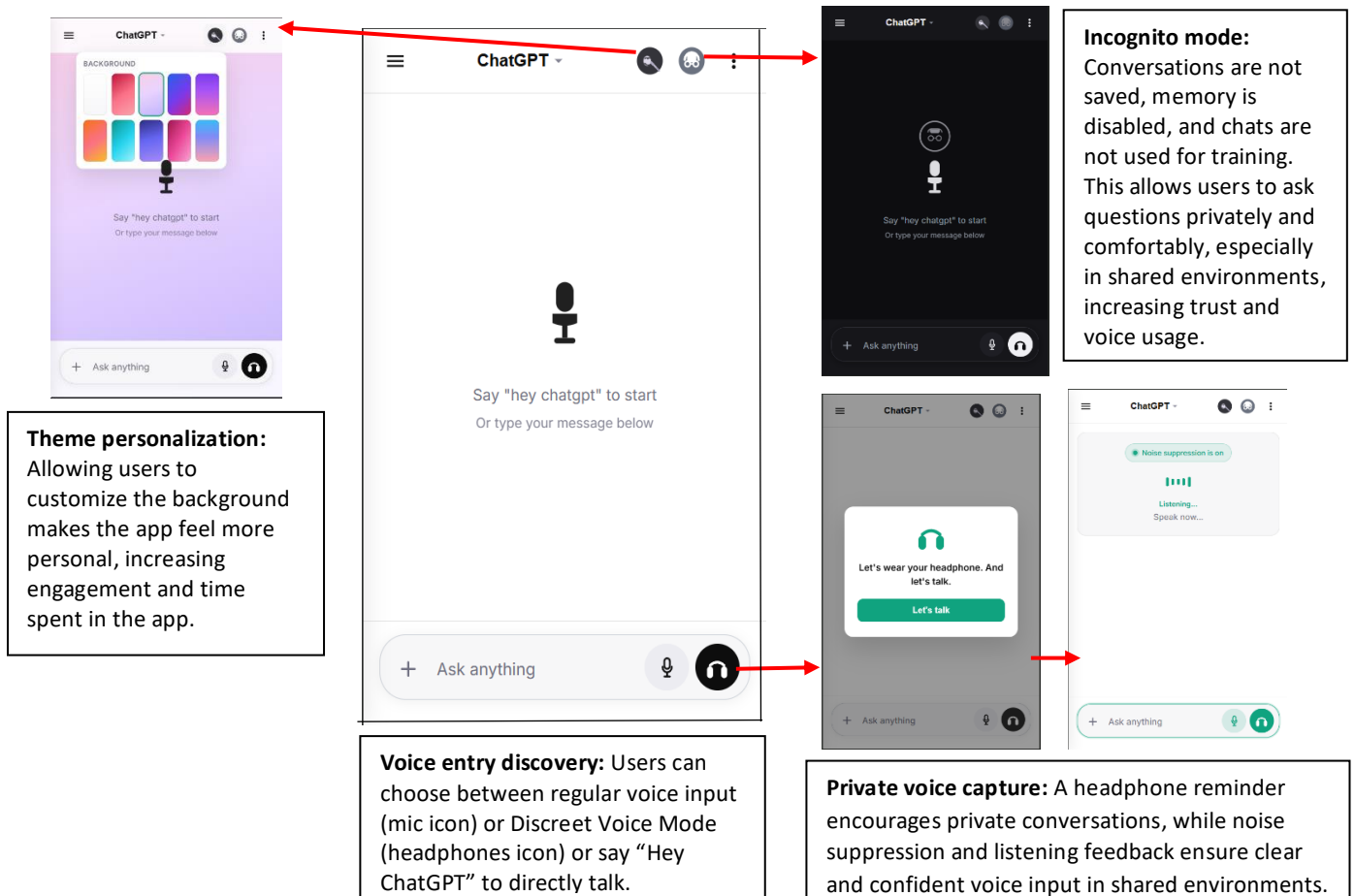
Private & Controlled Voice Experience was selected because it directly addresses the main barrier discomfort and hesitation while speaking in shared environments and has the highest impact on voice adoption among students.

User Flow



Wireframe

Prototype link: <https://chat-gpt-india.vercel.app/>



Key Features

- **“Hey ChatGPT” Voice Access** – Allows quick hands-free voice input.
- **Incognito Mode** – Conversations are not saved and memory is disabled for private queries.
- **Noise Suppression** – Reduces background noise for clearer voice input.
- **Push-to-Talk Control** – Users can control when the app listens and stops recording.
- **Live Transcription Preview** – Shows real-time text while speaking for better accuracy.
- **Editable Voice Draft** – Users can edit the transcript before sending.
- **Theme Personalization** – Users can customize the background to increase engagement and comfort.

Launch Readiness

Key Milestones

- **Design readiness:** User flows and wireframes for private voice interaction finalized
- **Technical discovery:** Feasibility of noise suppression, incognito mode, and editable draft confirmed
- **PRD finalization:** Feature logic, edge cases, and data tracking defined
- **Prototype build:** First prototype for private voice experience
- **QA testing:** Test transcription accuracy, noise handling, and latency
- **Experiment setup:** A/B test configured for student users

Launch Checklist

- **Product:** Final definition of private voice experience and success metrics
- **Engineering:** Data tracking, incognito logic, and error handling
- **Design:** Final UI screens, tooltips, and onboarding prompts
- **Data:** Metrics tracking plan finalized
- **Stakeholders:** Product, Engineering, Design, QA, Data

Experimentation Plan

- **Objective:** Test whether private voice features increase voice adoption and repeat usage among students
- **Design:** A/B test — Current voice vs Private voice experience
- **Primary metrics:** Voice Activation Rate, 7-Day Retention, Task Completion Rate
- **Rollout:** Launch to all users if metrics improve significantly

Open Questions & Decisions Taken

Descope Decisions

- Did not redesign the full ChatGPT voice conversation experience
- Did not modify core speech recognition or language models

Trade-offs Made

- Used **push-to-talk** instead of always listening to improve privacy and control
- Added **editable transcript** before sending to improve accuracy and trust, even if it adds one extra step
- Prioritized **privacy and comfort** over maximum speed of voice input

Open Questions

- Should noise suppression be enabled by default for all users?
- Should we add a short onboarding to explain private voice and incognito mode?
- Should theme personalization be expanded to more customization options?